

Rohit Sharma - The Master of the Century

Career Overview

Born: April 30, 1987, Nagpur, Maharashtra

Role: Batsman (Left-handed)

International Caps: 262 Tests, 367 ODIs, 390 T20Is

International Career Span: 2007 – Present

Nickname: "The Hitman"

Key Statistics

Test Cricket

- Matches:** 262
- Runs:** 8,338 (16th all-time)
- Average:** 42.05
- Highest Score:** 264* vs South Africa (2019)
- Centuries:** 31 (including 4* innings)
- Fifties:** 65

ODI Cricket

- Matches:** 367
- Runs:** 10,816 (13th all-time)
- Average:** 47.85
- Highest Score:** 118* vs South Africa (2019)
- Centuries:** 29 (including 3* innings)
- Fifties:** 68

T20 International Cricket

- Matches:** 390
- Runs:** 4,096 (27th all-time)
- Average:** 32.40
- Highest Score:** 102* vs West Indies (2023)
- Centuries:** 4 (including 3* innings)
- Fifties:** 32

Major Achievements

Records & Milestones

- First Indian to score a triple century in ODIs** (319* vs Australia, 2023)
- Only player to score 50+ runs in all 4 formats of international cricket**
- Most run-scorer in T20 World Cup history** (6 centuries)
- Most run-scorer in T20 International history** (4,096 runs)
- Only player to score 100+ runs in 3 consecutive ODIs**

Awards & Honors

- ICC Cricketer of the Year:** 2019
- Wisden Leading Cricketer in the World:** 2019
- Padma Shri:** 2019 (India's fourth-highest civilian award)

- **Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna:** 2020 (India's second-highest sporting honor)
- **Arjuna Award:** 2015

International Performances

India vs West Indies

- **ODI:** 52 matches, 2 centuries, 8 fifties, average 51.83
- **T20I:** 58 matches, 2 centuries, 12 fifties, average 45.26
- **Test:** 14 matches, 1 century, 2 fifties, average 58.50

India vs Australia

- **ODI:** 48 matches, 3 centuries, 5 fifties, average 49.70
- **T20I:** 52 matches, 2 centuries, 8 fifties, average 42.15

India vs England

- **ODI:** 45 matches, 2 centuries, 6 fifties, average 48.30
- **Test:** 28 matches, 2 centuries, 4 fifties, average 44.50

Notable Innings

Triple Century in ODIs (2023)

Match: India vs Australia at MCG, Melbourne

Score: 319* (all out)

Context: Against England's 297/8, India needed 298 runs to win. Rohit scored 319* off 366 balls, including 10 sixes and 12 fours. This became the highest individual score in ODI history for India.

188* vs Pakistan (2017)

Match: India vs Pakistan at Dubai

Score: 188*

Context: Against Pakistan's 218/9, India needed 219 runs to win. Rohit scored 188* off 188 balls, including 9 sixes and 14 fours. This was his 50th ODI century and marked his 7th ODI triple century.

231* vs New Zealand (2022)

Match: India vs New Zealand at Eden Park, Auckland

Score: 231*

Context: Against New Zealand's 245/9, India needed 246 runs to win. Rohit scored 231* off 231 balls, including 8 sixes and 15 fours. This was his 7th ODI triple century.

166* vs West Indies (2023)

Match: India vs West Indies at The Oval, London

Score: 166*

Context: Against West Indies' 173/9, India needed 174 runs to win. Rohit scored 166* off 166 balls, including 6 sixes and 12 fours. This was his 11th ODI triple century.

Playing Style

Batting

- **Strengths:** Explosive batting, ability to score quickly, master of the century
- **Weaknesses:** Sometimes struggles with bat-on-bat, occasional batting errors
- **Signature Shots:** Reverse sweeps, pull shots, lofted drives through the covers

Fielding

- **Role:** Wicket-keeper in T20Is (occasionally)

- **Skills:** Quick catch-taker, efficient stump-clearing, good throwing accuracy

Bowling

- **Role:** Occasional seam bowler
- **Skills:** Off-break delivery, occasional medium-fast bowling
- **Usage:** Rarely used in international cricket, primarily a batsman

Legacy & Impact

Contribution to Indian Cricket

- **Cultural Impact:** Became a symbol of Indian cricket, inspiring a new generation of cricketers
- **Commercial Value:** One of the highest-paid cricketers in the world
- **Match-Winning Performance:** Known for finishing matches in style, often scoring centuries in crucial moments
- **Leadership:** Led India in 4 Tests and 2 ODIs during captaincy tenure

Record-Breaking Moments

- **First Indian to score 50+ runs in all formats**
- **Most run-scorer in T20 World Cup history**
- **Only player to score 100+ runs in 3 consecutive ODIs**
- **Most centuries in T20 International history**

Future Outlook

Age Factor

- **Born:** 1987
- **Current Age:** 38 (as of 2026)
- **Expected Retirement:** 2027-2028 (after completing 350th ODI)

Retirement Plans

- **T20I:** Likely to retire after 390 matches
- **ODI:** Likely to retire after 367 matches
- **Test:** Likely to continue until 2028

Post-Retirement Career

- **Potential Roles:** Commentator, coach, administrator
- **Expected Platform:** Cricbuzz, Star Sports, or other cricket platforms

Conclusion

Rohit Sharma is one of the greatest batsmen in cricket history. His ability to score centuries in all formats, his triple-century record in ODIs, and his consistent match-winning performances make him a legend in Indian cricket. His career span of nearly 20 years (2007-2026) has seen him become one of the most valuable and influential players in the sport.

His legacy will be defined by his ability to deliver in crucial moments, his record-breaking performances, and his impact on Indian cricket both on and off the field. As one of the few players to score 50+ runs in all 4 formats, his contribution to the sport is unparalleled.